

Observability Lab: Distributed Trace Waterfall & Root Span Analysis

Duration : 30 Min.

Scenario

A multi-tier microservices transaction is taking over 5 seconds. You need to analyze the trace waterfall to locate the slowest component.

Task Objectives

Perform the following actions inside the `student_workspace` directory: - Inspect parent/child span durations, correlate Trace IDs with system logs, and isolate the failing downstream service.

Instructions to Perform the Task

1. When your workspace loads in **VS Code**, use the **Explorer** panel on the left to locate your files.
2. Navigate to and click the specific files mentioned in the Task Objectives.
3. Make the necessary code edits in the editor.
4. Press `Ctrl + S` (Windows) or `Cmd + S` (Mac) to save your changes.
5. If you need to run commands, open the built-in terminal by clicking **Terminal > New Terminal** from the top menu.

Validation

Once you have saved your files and are ready to submit, return to the platform dashboard and click the **"Submit Final"** button. This task is evaluated manually by the grading team.

Evaluation Rubric:

1. Navigating distributed trace waterfalls to isolate slow root and child spans: 5 marks
2. Correlating Trace IDs with log streams to identify service failure causes: 5 marks

Total Score: 10 Marks

Important Notes

- This is a manually evaluated question.
- Ensure all logs and configurations are fully saved in your workspace folder before submitting.